

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Law English

Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Find the right language. Speak, write, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For lawyers, paralegals, compliance staff, contracts specialists, legal operations teams, and law-adjacent professionals.

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Legal English Mindset: Facts, Issues, Rules, Risk

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

02 Client Intake, Scope, Conflicts, and Confidentiality

Clarify missing information before responding.

03 Litigation Lifecycle: Pleadings, Motions, Deadlines, Strategy

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

04 Discovery, ESI, Privilege Review, and Depositions

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

05 Legal Research, Authority, and Memo Writing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

06 Contracts, Redlines, and Negotiation

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

07 Corporate, Compliance, Regulatory, and Investigation Language

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

08 Advocacy, Settlement, Ethics, and Professional Judgment

Include relevant voices and clarify the decision process.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one case and saying a response. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, conversation, writing, and revision.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Legal English Mindset: Facts, Issues, Rules, Risk

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An internal case note says a supplier "breached the contract." The team has the delivery email but has not reviewed the signed agreement.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Jurisdiction - A court's legal authority to hear a matter or exercise power over a party or subject.

Materiality - Importance of information to a legal, regulatory, investor, or business decision.

Allege - State a claim or fact as asserted but not yet proven.

Assert - State a position, claim, right, defense, or privilege.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In every location, the result will be ...
 - B. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Client Intake, Scope, Conflicts, and Confidentiality

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A prospective client sends a long description of a dispute and asks for immediate advice. The intake team has not completed its conflict check.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Conflict of interest - A situation where duties to one client, former client, third person, or personal interest may limit representation.

Confidentiality - The professional duty to protect information relating to a client or matter, subject to applicable rules.

Engagement letter - A document defining the representation, scope, fees, responsibilities, and sometimes limitations.

Scope of representation - The agreed boundaries of legal work to be performed.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Improve this sentence: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Litigation Lifecycle: Pleadings, Motions, Deadlines, Strategy

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A litigation task list has two dates from different documents. The supervising lawyer has not confirmed which deadline controls.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Complaint - A pleading that starts a civil lawsuit by stating claims against the defendant.

Answer - A defendant's pleading responding to the complaint and often asserting defenses.

Motion - A request asking the court to issue an order or take action.

Order - A court's direction or decision on a matter before it.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Improve this sentence: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team plans to complete the review.
 - B. The team has completed the review.
 - C. The team is completing the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - B. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.
 - C. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Discovery, ESI, Privilege Review, and Depositions

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A document reviewer finds an email chain that may contain privileged communications. It is in a review set, not yet a production set.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Discovery - The formal process for obtaining information and evidence from other parties or nonparties.

Deposition - Out-of-court sworn testimony recorded for use in litigation.

Privilege - A legal protection that may permit withholding certain communications or materials.

Work product - Materials prepared in anticipation of litigation that may receive protection from disclosure.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Improve this sentence: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - B. Send it only after Thursday.
 - C. Send it on a date later than Thursday.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you deal with the relevant matters soon?
 - B. Could you do the needful for the situation?
 - C. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Legal Research, Authority, and Memo Writing

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

A draft memo cites one decision as controlling authority. The case came from another jurisdiction and the research is still preliminary.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Binding authority - Authority a court must follow in the relevant jurisdiction and procedural context.

Persuasive authority - Authority a court may consider but does not have to follow.

Precedent - A prior decision used as legal authority for later cases.

Distinguish - Explain why a case or authority does not control because facts or law differ materially.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Improve this sentence: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is an important operational backlog.
 - B. The backlog must be reviewed at the backlog meeting.
 - C. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. You understand everything now, don't you?
 - B. How would you describe the next step in your own words?
 - C. I have explained the next step, so shall we finish?

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Contracts, Redlines, and Negotiation

Negotiate scope or timing while making conditions explicit.

SITUATION

A draft services agreement requires delivery within ten days. The commercial team needs fifteen days and wants the contract team to propose wording.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Representation - A statement of fact made by a party, often used to allocate risk.

Warranty - A promise or assurance about a fact, condition, product, service, or performance.

Indemnity - A clause requiring one party to cover certain losses, claims, or liabilities.

Limitation of liability - A clause limiting the amount or type of damages recoverable.

3. Notice the language

Acknowledge the goal and explain the available choices. Connect an offer to its actual conditions. A useful response makes room for discussion without promising approval or resources you do not control.

We can ..., provided that

Would you prefer ... or ...?

I can take that proposal for review; I cannot yet confirm

Improve this sentence: If you will approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Offer a workable tradeoff

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence presents a normal future condition clearly?
 - A. If the scope changed tomorrow, we reviewed the schedule yesterday.
 - B. If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.
 - C. If the scope will change, we review yesterday's schedule.
2. Which response negotiates a new request without silently promising extra work?
 - A. We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.
 - B. We have included it, although its scope has not been reviewed.
 - C. We guarantee the original date without assessing the addition.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You want the preferred outcome but can accept one tradeoff. Ask for two options, then state which condition you can accept and which still needs approval.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Corporate, Compliance, Regulatory, and Investigation Language

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

An employee interview contains a report of possible misconduct. A manager asks to describe the allegation as a confirmed violation in a summary.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Due diligence - Structured review of facts, documents, obligations, and risks before a transaction or decision.

Disclosure - Providing required or relevant information to a party, regulator, investor, court, or public filing.

Enforcement action - A regulator's action to investigate, stop, penalize, or remedy alleged violations.

Remediation - Corrective action taken to fix a problem and prevent recurrence.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Improve this sentence: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In every location, the result will be ...
 - B. Without any uncertainty, the result is ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Advocacy, Settlement, Ethics, and Professional Judgment

Include relevant voices and clarify the decision process.

SITUATION

Two team members disagree about settlement priorities. One prioritizes timing; the other prioritizes confidentiality. Counsel is preparing for a client discussion.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

Settle - Resolve a dispute by agreement rather than final adjudication.

Reserve rights - State that a party is not waiving rights or remedies by acting now.

Stipulate - Agree formally to a fact, issue, procedure, or condition.

Object - State a legal objection to a question, evidence, request, or procedure.

3. Notice the language

Summarize the issue neutrally, invite missing perspectives, and distinguish discussion from decision. State who can decide and record any unresolved question. Do not assume silence means agreement.

Let's hear ... before we decide.

The point we still need to resolve is

Who will make this decision, and what do they need?

Improve this sentence: Nobody objected, so everyone agrees.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Help a group reach a clear next step

4. Check the language

1. Which phrase invites a missing perspective?
 - A. The remote team has been quiet, so they must agree.
 - B. We can record their agreement without asking them.
 - C. We haven't heard from the remote team yet; what is your view?
2. Which closing statement records an unresolved decision accurately?
 - A. Everyone spoke, so the decision must be final.
 - B. Approval is pending; the sponsor will review the two options.
 - C. We discussed the options, so approval is complete.

5. Say it

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You hold a relevant concern that has not been discussed. Raise it when invited and ask who will decide. Help the facilitator state one unresolved question accurately.

6. Write it

Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

After checking the answer section, revise one sentence and try the spoken response again.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response, not a script to memorize. Your written version needs a subject line, an opening, and appropriate context. Assess it using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Legal English Mindset: Facts, Issues, Rules, Risk

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

B: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The delivery email records a delay. Whether that amounts to a breach requires review of the agreement and relevant law. I'll separate the documented facts from the legal questions in the note.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Client Intake, Scope, Conflicts, and Confidentiality

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: what this means.

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: the review starts.

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Before we discuss advice, could you provide the names of the parties and the type of assistance you are seeking? Our team needs to complete intake and confirm the scope of any engagement.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Litigation Lifecycle: Pleadings, Motions, Deadlines, Strategy

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: B - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

B: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

C: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

Check 2: A - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

B: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

C: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

Model response: The task list contains conflicting dates. I have attached both source documents and flagged the issue for your review. Please confirm the controlling deadline before I update the calendar.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Discovery, ESI, Privilege Review, and Depositions

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: A - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

B: This reverses the meaning of the deadline.

C: A later date does not meet a 'by Thursday' deadline.

Check 2: C - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: 'Relevant matters' and 'soon' leave the task unclear.

B: This expression does not identify the specific action needed.

C: The requested action and information are explicit.

Model response: Please review this email chain for potential privilege before a production decision. I've identified the participants and relevant messages. I have not made a final privilege determination.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Legal Research, Authority, and Memo Writing

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: C - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: Repeating the same term does not define it.

B: This describes a meeting but leaves the term unexplained.

C: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

Check 2: B - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: This leading question makes it easy to agree without showing understanding.

B: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

C: Finishing the conversation gives no evidence of understanding.

Model response: This decision may help the analysis, but we should not label it binding without checking its authority in the relevant jurisdiction. I'll explain that distinction and identify what further research is needed.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Contracts, Redlines, and Negotiation

Editing example: If you approve the scope, we can assess the schedule.

For an ordinary future condition, the if-clause uses present tense. The other clause can express the future consequence or possibility.

Check 1: B - If the scope changes, we will review the schedule.

A: The conflicting time references make the condition unclear.

B: The if-clause uses present tense; the main clause states the future response.

C: The tense pattern and time reference do not express the intended future condition.

Check 2: A - We can assess the addition and explain its effect on the agreed scope.

A: This offers a useful next step while keeping the approval and scope question open.

B: It treats unreviewed work as already included.

C: It promises an outcome without examining the consequences.

Model response: Our delivery team can commit to fifteen days under the current scope. Could we revise the proposed period accordingly? I'll send the business rationale for legal review with the redline.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Corporate, Compliance, Regulatory, and Investigation Language

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: The pilot does not establish future results everywhere.

B: This removes uncertainty rather than explaining its limits.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: At this stage, we have an allegation and an interview record. The finding is not established. I'll use neutral wording and identify the questions that the investigation still needs to resolve.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Advocacy, Settlement, Ethics, and Professional Judgment

Editing example: Before I record agreement, does anyone have a concern or need more time?

The revised question gives people a way to raise a concern. Silence can have several meanings, especially in unfamiliar or unequal-power situations.

Check 1: C - We haven't heard from the remote team yet; what is your view?

A: Silence does not establish agreement.

B: Recording agreement without checking may misrepresent the team's view.

C: It invites participation without interpreting silence as consent.

Check 2: B - Approval is pending; the sponsor will review the two options.

A: Participation alone does not establish a decision.

B: This distinguishes discussion from approval and identifies the next reviewer.

C: Discussion does not itself constitute approval.

Model response: Let's separate the objectives before discussing terms. How important are timing and confidentiality to the client? We can present the options and their implications for the client's instructions.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

Fictional language practice. Legal, financial, and regulatory meanings depend on jurisdiction and context; use current documents and qualified review for actual decisions.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

US Courts: glossary of legal terms

<https://www.uscourts.gov/glossary>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.